

RIJU GARG

DATE OF BIRTH: 22 MARCH 2002

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EDUCATION

Madras School of Economics

M.A. General Economics

2023 - 2025

- GPA: 8.0/10
- Courses: Applied Econometrics, Intermediate Macroeconomics, International Trade, Mathematical Statistics, Development Economics, Public Economics, Game Theory
- Thesis: *Examining Total Factor Productivity in India's Unincorporated Manufacturing Enterprises: Stylized Facts and Determinants*
Carried out unit-level extraction process from ASUSE 2022-23 to find total factor productivity (TFP) using VAKL model and analyzed the impact of self-reported operational problems such as demand shrinkage, credit issues and 20 other indicators on productivity, under Dr Gopal Krishna Roy.

Maitreyi College, University of Delhi

B.A. (H) Economics

2020 - 2023

- GPA: 8.527/10
- Courses: Macroeconomics, Money and Financial Markets, Law and Economics, Data Analysis, Mathematical Methods for Economics

WORK EXPERIENCE

Reserve Bank of India | Mumbai

2026/01 - Present

- Research Intern at Division of Local Finances, Department of Economic and Policy Research (DEPR).
- Analysed ASUSE 2023–24 data to study firm performance in the rural unincorporated sector, integrating administrative datasets (e.g., district-level developmental expenditure, Mission Antyodaya) to examine the effects of public spending on firm outcomes.
- Supported the Division Report on Panchayat Finances through data visualisation and proofreading.

Nation First Policy Research & Change Foundation | Noida

2025/08 - 2025/12

- Public Policy Consultant, Centre for Accelerating India's Growth.
- Delivered evidence-based policy analysis and impact evaluations for major government programmes (e.g., Jal Jeevan Mission), leading survey design, fieldwork, stakeholder consultations, econometric analysis, and policy briefs to inform implementation and reform.
- Final report of the Jal Jeevan Mission evaluation published with official recognition from the Ministry of Jal Shakti, Government of India.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Informal Economy, Economic Growth, Sustainability, Industrial Productivity, Development Economics, Applied Econometrics

WORKING PAPERS

1. **Garg, R., Sankaran, S.** *Determinants of Enterprise Performance in Rural Unincorporated Sector*. 2026.

The study uses ASUSE 2023–24 data, along with district-level development expenditure and village-level infrastructure indicators, to examine the drivers of the performance of rural unincorporated proprietary enterprises across 21 states in India.

2. **Sarma, R., Garg, R.** *The Himalayan Tighrope: Balancing Growth and Sustainability in an Ecologically- Sensitive Ecosystem*. 2025.

The study uses high-resolution town- and village-level satellite data to examine the relationship between infrastructure development, environmental sustainability, and growth in the ecologically sensitive Himalayan biome. It builds a novel two-decade dataset covering five economic and environmental indicators and finds significant spatial and temporal heterogeneity, with implications for sustainable development and decentralized policy-making.

POLICY REPORT	1. Sriram, M., Garg, R., Choudhary, S., et al. <i>Strengthening the Rural Water Service Paradigm: A Policy Evaluation of Jal Jeevan Mission and Pathways for Sustainable Delivery</i>. Centre for Accelerating India's Growth, NFPRC Foundation. 2026. Policy evaluation of the Jal Jeevan Mission using primary survey data from 3,065 households across 12 districts in six states. Examines programme implementation, service reliability, tap functionality, water quality, and household welfare outcomes, with recommendations for strengthening source sustainability, operations and maintenance financing, local governance, and long-term rural water service delivery.	
CONFERENCES	59th Conference of the Indian Econometric Society <i>Banaras Hindu University</i> 2025/03 Kautilya Colloquy <i>Kautilya School of Public Policy</i> 2024/09 Avlokan 2022 <i>Maitreyi College</i> 2022/09 Equinox: The Annual International Conference <i>Maitreyi College</i> 2022/08	
AWARDS	• Best Presenter, Kautilya Colloquy, Kautilya School of Public Policy 2024/09 • All Rounder Achiever Award, Economics Department, Maitreyi College 2023/06	
SKILLS	Stata: unit-level data extraction, advanced econometrics, visualizations G-Suite: forms, sheets, documentation MS Office: documentation and presentations; Excel functions R: data manipulation, visualization Git: repository management LaTeX: documentation, presentations QGIS: geospatial analysis and visualization	
REFEREES	Dr. Gopal Krishna Roy Assistant Professor Madras School of Economics Chennai, TN Email: gopal.roy@mse.ac.in	Ms. Subhadhra Sankaran Deputy General Manager, DEPR Reserve Bank of India Mumbai, MH Email: subhadhras@rbi.org.in
INTERESTS AND ACTIVITIES	• Editor, Economics Departmental Magazine, Maitreyi College 2022-23 • Secretary, Economics Association, Maitreyi College 2021-22 • Graphic Designer, Achievement Cell, University of Delhi 2021-22 • Member, Abhivyakti- Theatre Society, Maitreyi College 2020-21	